



HOW TO GET BIG ARMS

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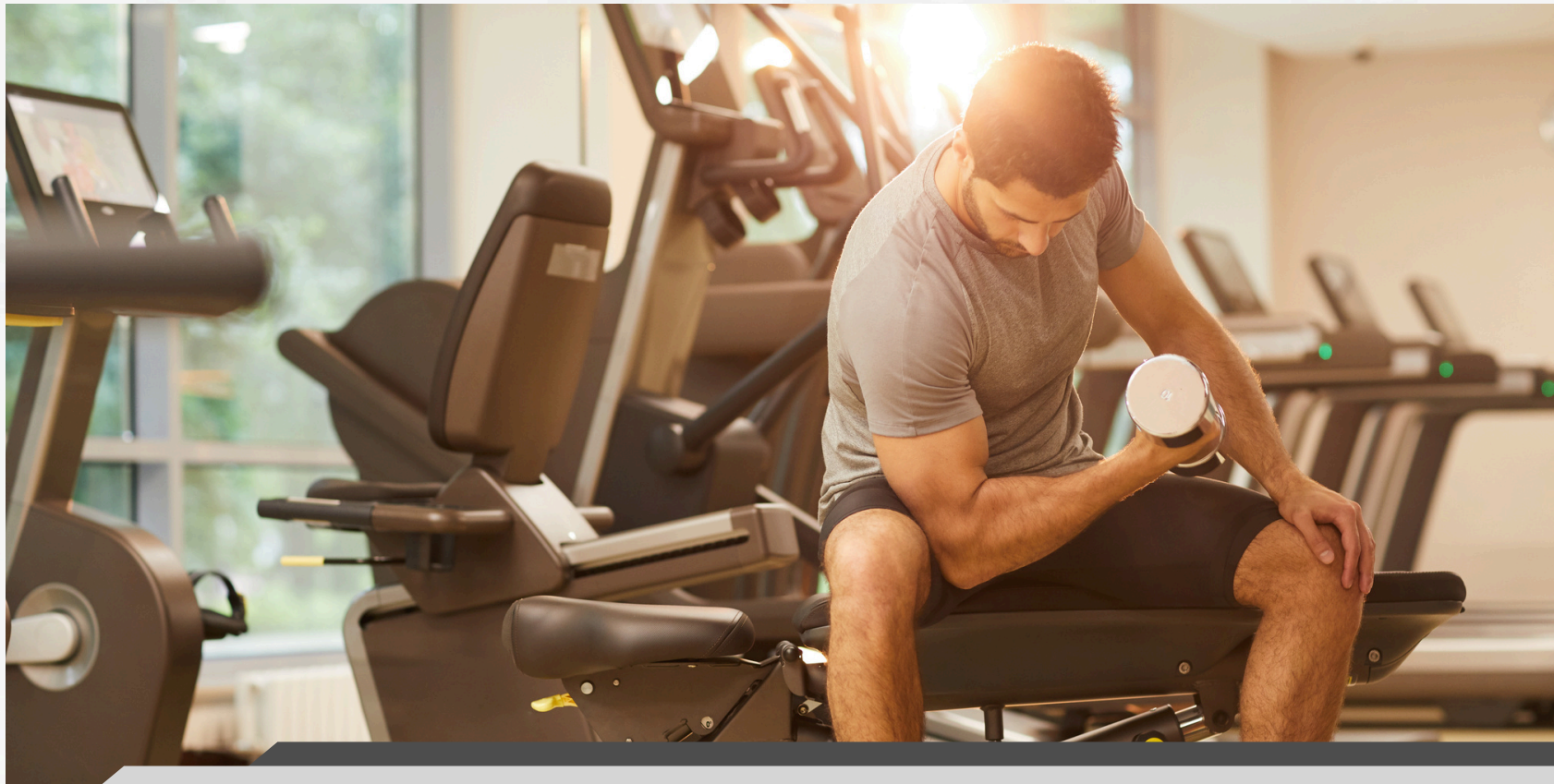
Big, muscular and ripped arms. Nothing tells the world, “I work out” like a pair of well-developed biceps, triceps and forearms. In fact, when someone says “show me your muscle” we instinctively know to flex our upper arm. This makes sense considering its your arms that are usually displayed (if anything is to be displayed) to the world when fully dressed...a simple t-shirt shows them off. It also makes sense because its your arms that CONNECT you to the world and we use our arms to handle and manipulate objects. Muscular and well-defined arms usually means someone spends a decent amount of time in the gym.

As a personal trainer, clients come to me with all kinds of requests. The most common general goals are to lose weight or to gain muscle (or both) but when asked get specific with areas of their body that they wanted to focus on, “arms” is unanimously in the top 3. Even my female clients want to build and define the muscles of their arms. There always has been a strong demand from fitness clients for developed arms.



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When you consider the popularity of wanting well developed arms, its no wonder that arm training is riddled with myths and bro science. Its been this way for decades. I remember reading the latest muscle magazines as a kid and regardless of what edition I was reading there was ALWAYS an article about some new “secret” for arm training...and the secret was usually hype and crap information. Its no different today. Knowing what I know now through my experiences, I can tell you with full confidence that the reasons that the VAST MAJORITY of people who struggle with arm development can be narrowed down to 3 major mistakes and myths. You probably fall into this category. Read this guide and apply these time tested and basic principles within it and watch your arms finally respond and GROW.



— MISTAKE ONE

RELYING TOO MUCH ON ISOLATION EXERCISES

Here are two questions most people get wrong: Which exercise will build bigger biceps? Curls or chin ups? Which exercise builds bigger triceps? Cable press downs or heavy dips? If you are like most people you probably said curls and cable press downs, and like most people you would be **WRONG**. 9/10 times when I meet someone who works out a lot but who also has weak arm development they are also usually weak for their body weight in the basic heavy compound pulling and pushing movements.

You can break all exercises into two major categories...isolation or single joint movements and compound or gross motor movements. Isolation movements typically mainly involve one joint while compound movements involve two joints. A curl is a single joint (only utilizes the elbow) movement while a chin up is a compound movement (utilizes the elbow and the shoulder). When you ask any strength coach or experienced body builder worth their salt which category of movements builds the most muscle the vast majority will side with the compound movements. This part isn't even controversial.

In fact if I asked you, which exercise would build bigger quads, leg extensions or squats you would say squats and you would be right. **NO ONE** would debate this...but when I say the **EXACT SAME THING** about curls vs chin ups or press downs vs dips people lose their minds. **IT'S THE SAME PHENOMENA!!** Need some evidence? Go look at the biceps of your run of the mill gymnasts. They have bigger biceps and arms than the run of the mill gym bro and they



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NEVER do curls...they just do lots and lots of heavy pulling or chin up type movements. Now, I am not saying that curls or cable press downs don't have value, of course they do, but if you base your arm development on curls and variations of curls and on all variations of tricep extensions, and you don't pay attention to getting stronger at heavy pulling and pushing movements like chin ups or presses you will miss out on gaining inches of hard and strong muscles.

I have seen male clients add an inch or more to their arms by simply focusing on GETTING STRONGER at heavy pulling movements and pressing movements while eliminating isolation exercises all together. I have never seen anyone gain size and muscularity on their arms by doing the opposite. To be clear I am NOT saying you should avoid isolation exercises and only focus on compound ones. All I am saying is to make the compound movements your priorities and throw in 3-5 week heavy strength cycles where you try to get stronger in lifts like chin ups, barbell rows, dips, bench press etc. Add 10-15 kg to these lifts and the high odds are that your arms will grow.

MISTAKE TWO

NOT TRAINING THE ARMS FREQUENTLY ENOUGH

In the very early days of weight training (before steroids and protein powders) strongmen and body builders trained very differently than we see today. They all trained their entire bodies, including their arms, between 3-5 days a week. Today its RARE to see anyone train a body part more than twice a week. In fact the bro split of training one body part a day thus training each body part once a week is the most common. Its no coincidence that weak muscles and small arms are also common.

This current trend of training body parts infrequently kicked off with the introduction of steroids. Once body builders started taking steroids it was no longer imperative to train frequently. All they had to do is hammer a muscle group hard and long once a week and they built muscle. This simply does not work for the vast majority of you natural lifters. When you lift weights, you send a muscle building signal. We can measure this signal through something called "muscle protein synthesis."

Studies show that this signal elevates strongly following a workout and peaks at about 24-48 hours and then it drops FAST. After about 48-72 hours it hits baseline and then even starts to drop below baseline. EVEN if you feel sore this happens. People who take steroids don't have to worry about this, but natural lifters do.

Studies also show that the more experienced you are the shorter this muscle building signal lasts. Advanced lifters may only have an elevated signal for 14 hours!!! If you are like most of the people in these studies you need to send that muscle building signal FREQUENTLY. Maybe as often as every single day. Sounds easy enough, but if you train and hammer your arms every day you will find yourself super sore, inflamed and over trained from the cumulative damage. So, how do we get around this problem? By manipulating intensity.

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First off start training your arms 3 times a week with a relatively high amount of intensity. Train hard on these days, but don't lift to failure...instead stop about 1-2 reps short of it. Failure is too much intensity for most people most of the time. Take the current total amount of volume you do for your arms for the week and divide it over 3 workouts. For most people this looks like 12-21 sets TOTAL for the week per muscle. EXAMPLE: If 12 sets for the week is your goal for biceps then do 4 sets three days a week on Mondays, Wednesdays and Fridays.

On the days in between those hard workouts do trigger sessions. These are short 5-10 minute low intensity "pumping" sessions that you do up to 3 times a day. Pick 2-3 exercises with very light weights or bands (ideal) for your biceps and triceps and get a small pump. Do this in the morning, the afternoon and in the evening on the days you DON'T do heavy arm training. You will feel these working in the first day. Expect the pumps with trigger sessions to get more and more pronounced and easier to achieve. These trigger sessions keep that muscle building signal elevated every single day.





MISTAKE THREE

LETTING WORKOUTS GET STALE AKA NOT “PHASING” WORKOUTS

There is a rule in muscle building...everything works but nothing works forever. I don't care how awesome your workout routine, exercise selection and rep range selection is...at some point your body will stop responding. When people get stuck in this situation they tend to just ramp up the intensity or they make small changes like focusing more on the squeeze of a rep. I am here to tell you that after a period of weeks if you don't **FUNDAMENTALLY** change your programming your body will not reach its fullest muscle building potential.

Changing the exercises you do is very important, but what is more important is to change your rep range. Most rep ranges have muscle building value but training in each of them is an entirely different experience. Try comparing sets of squats for 20 reps to sets of squats for 2 reps. **VERY** different yet both rep ranges build muscle.

The main muscle building rep ranges can be broken down into three categories: **LOW** reps (1-5 reps), **MODERATE REPS** (8-12 reps) and **HIGH REPS** (15-20 reps). Each of them has been **PROVEN** to build muscle.

The low rep ranges are excellent for building maximal grinding strength. Its also been observed that the low rep ranges build hard and dense looking muscle. I once had a client that competed as a high-level physique competitor and he almost never utilized low reps. Once I convinced him to do some heavy low rep strength training his physique took on a whole new look. He added lbs of hard and dense muscle and became a convert. Now he regularly cycles in periods of low rep training.

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The moderate rep range is the classic muscle building body builder rep range. In studies when compared to other rep ranges head to head the 8-12 reps range builds the most muscle every single time. This is probably why most people get stuck in this rep range, and once they get stuck for a few months their bodies stop responding. This rep range is awesome when its cycled with other rep ranges.

The high rep range is brutal. This rep range can make workouts feel like marathon sessions. They are exhausting but they also produce the craziest skin bursting pumps. That's the main benefit of this range...the pump. Remember, your arm size is mostly non-muscle fiber structures and fluid...as much as 70%. Train your arms to get crazy pumps with high reps and they will increase their capacity to store more non muscle fiber structures and fluids within them which means they will be BIGGER.

In my experience the best way to utilise the above rep ranges is to cycle them all every 3-5 weeks. Start in one rep range and after a few week move to a new rep range and watch your arms respond every single time. No more plateaus...at least not until you start to reach your genetic potential.

That is it folks. Do the above and be consistent and watch your arms finally respond. Forget the crazy techniques and supplements, just focus on getting strong at big, gross motor compound movements, train your arms daily with three heavy workouts and trigger sessions on all other days and cycle your rep ranges every 3-5 weeks and you will see results like you never have before.

THANK YOU FROM LIFT2LAST

First off, congratulations for downloading and making it to the end of this guide! Taking the time to invest in your knowledge is the first step toward better health and fitness.

I truly hope the information in these pages helps you move the needle on your fitness goals today. But I also know that, sometimes, a PDF can only take you so far. Most successful, sustainable change happens when a plan is built specifically for your life, your body, and your long-term goals.

That is why I founded Lift2Last. We focus on:

- Personalised 1-on-1 coaching that is tailored to you
- Building functional strength that promotes longevity and boosts your energy
- Combining efficient digital tools with real human support to guide you through the tough moments and inspire true confidence.

If you are tired of putting in your best efforts but are not seeing the results you deserve, let's talk. I want to help you build a strategy that is actually made for you.

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Let's see if we are the right fit to help you Lift to Last.

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